Program Review Two-Year Cycle (2015-2017)
Licensed Vocation Nursing (LVN) Program
Kim Parham, Assistant Director, Faculty
Hallie Coppi, Faculty
Karen Harper, Faculty
Rhonda Brown, Faculty
Cora Brownell, Director
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I. Description of the Program

The Vocational Nursing program is a three-semester program designed to prepare students to be eligible to take the national licensing exam (NCLEX-PN) to then become active working members in the healthcare profession. The program meets the Board of Vocation Nursing and Psychiatric Technician (BVNPT) minimum standards of curriculum required hours: 596 theory hours and 974 clinical hours. The program also serves as the necessary prerequisite content for the graduate looking to advance and be admitted into an LVN to RN program.

Curriculum content begins with instruction in basic areas, includes a holistic focus, and progresses to care of individuals with more complex problems, illnesses and diseases. The instructional plan has been developed to allow the student to build on previous knowledge and experience in order to provide increased technical skills, incorporate understanding of health and wellness, identify self-care and learning needs, and promote self-actualization of individuals and families while providing care. The clinical experiences allow students to work directly with patients in a variety of healthcare settings within the community.

a) Organization

Director of Nursing- ***Cora Brownell MSN, RN***
Assistant Director-*Kim Parham MSN, RN*

<u>Instructors approved to teach all content:</u>

Kim Parham MSN, RN –Tenured Faculty
Hallie Coppi MSN, RN—Tenured Faculty
Rhonda Brown MSN, RN—Tenure Track Faculty
Karen Harper BSN, RN—Tenure Track Faculty

<u>Part-Time Clinical Faculty*</u>

Penny Huleatt, RN; Katherine Durett, RN; Eric Ricohermoso, RN;
Kara Gardner, RN
*Per BVNT requirements consist of a maximum of 15:1 ratio for instructor to students in each clinical setting.

b) Primary purpose

The Vocational Nursing program is based on the precept that nursing supports an individual or family in a movement toward health and that the whole person, including the psychological, social and physical aspects of the person's being, be considered in planning and implementing nursing care. The educative goal of the Vocational Nursing Program is that upon completion, the nurse will possess a broad base of nursing knowledge, an understanding of nursing principles and the nursing process, as well as being able to perform skills and techniques competently. Through a planned course of study, it is expected that the students will develop a sense of ethics and integrity not only for themselves but to the patient, the health care team and to vocational nurses as a group. The faculty view each student as a unique individual with special abilities, talents, needs, and goals. Cultural diversity, varying life experiences, and changing socioeconomic factors affect each student differently. The faculty function as role model, coach, motivator, facilitator, and resources in the learning process by providing direction for learning and growth as a health care provider. Adult learning principles are the basis for teaching.

c) Whom we serve include demographics

Our vocational nursing program serves a wide variety of student populations including age (has ranged from 19-65 years of age), ethnicity, and gender (see below)*. Our program has encompassed students across multiple counties not just those in Siskiyou County though Siskiyou County residents do make up the largest population of entry students. Two of our next largest counties for student population are Shasta and Jackson (Southern Oregon).

Row Labels	Count of Student_Race
NURS	1268
African American	6
American Indian/Alaskan Native	46
Asian	22
Filipino	19
Hispanic	91
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander	6
Other/Unknown	89
Two or more	125
White	864
Grand Total	1268

Row Labels	Count of Student_Gender
NURS	1268
F	1099
M	142
N	26
Unknown / Not Collected	1

*The presented table data includes student enrollment across ALL nursing courses and does not represent just those of the LVN program. The data is still a reliable source; many students progress through all individual programs (CNA, LVN, ADN).

d) What kind of services we provide:

- BVNPT approved curriculum. The curriculum includes theory/ clinical/ skills lab/ simulation/remediation in core nursing content. Core nursing content includes Fundamentals of Nursing, Medical-Surgical, Pharmacology, Pediatrics and Obstetrics, and Mental Health.
- Assessment Technologies Institute (ATI), a National Council Licensure Examination (NCLEX) vendor that provides NCLEX preparedness tutorials, quiz banks, practice tests, and proctored tests in all areas of NCLEX content areas of testing.
- Tutoring specific to nursing.
- First hand exposure to many areas the nursing profession has to offer once licensed.
- Partnerships with local healthcare agencies where program graduates can be employed.
- Provide the community with qualified and competent nursing professionals.

e) How services are provided:

- Degree applicable courses
  - At the end of the LVN program graduates are eligible for certificate of Achievements and/or an Associate in Science

Awards - Years	Count of Award
Licensed Vocational Nursing - Associate in Science	**46**
2015	10
2016	8
2017	12
2018	16
Licensed Vocational Nursing - Certificate of Achievement	**124**
2015	41
2016	20
2017	41
2018	22

- Transferable courses for LVN to RN then to BSN.

f) Curriculum Current and needs based:

The LVN curriculum has not had a major revision since 2006 and is in dire need to be completed revised: all courses and content. The plan is to start working on this and have completed in 2019.

g) Class Breakdown:

Semester 1: 0951	**Semester 2: 0952**	**Semester 3: 0953**
Fundamentals of Nursing 15 Units	*Medical-Surgical and Pediatrics* 15 Units	*Medical-Surgical and Mental Health* 14 Units
0851: Support Lab 0.5 Units	*0852: Support Lab* 0.5 Units	*0853: Support Lab* 0.5 Units

II. External Factors with Significant Impact

a) Budgetary constraints or opportunities: Career and Technical Education (CTE), nursing included, are expensive programs due to many of the Board regulations and requirements. This program has been fortunate to have funding from some grants throughout the years but those grants have not been able to fully offset the costs to run a high-quality program. As a program we are looking at ways to increase cost savings.

b) Competition from other institutions: None. Our enrollment is typically at maximum capacity (30 students per cohort) with waitlists for new cohort starts.

c) Requirements for four -year institutions: N/A

d) Institutional regulation, policies, standards, and other mandates:

- Having worked with the 16-week compressed calendar now for a couple of years, this continues to pose hours requirement problems for the program. The program has a set number of hours required by the BVNPT for any graduate to be eligible to register for the NCLEX. The new calendar has made if more difficult to fit all of the clinical and theory hours especially when we have overlapping cohorts. Students find the material more rushed and not as able to digest the large amount of content we are required to cover.

e) Non-Institutional regulation, policies, standards, and other mandates:

- Finding and retaining part-time clinical faculty has significant impact on our program success. It is difficult to find nurses who meet both the requirements of the college and the BVNPT. Part of the difficulty in this is the ratio of students to instructor (15:1) with the hospital requests of having no more than 10 students per rotation group; it is also safer to have a 10:1 ratio. With a cohort of 30 students occupying clinical time in 3 varying groups this requires minimally 4-5 faculty members to be available (taking into account the maximum number of hours a PT faculty member can have). Many of our PT clinical faculty view working for the college and the program as their second job and long-term commitment can be a challenge.
- One other significant impact on the program is the availability of clinical sites and the rural nature of our local hospitals. Though the LVN program has been very fortunate in clinical site placement due to our strong partnerships with advisory members in our community (many of which are previous graduates of the COS nursing program), the lack of patient census is not always conducive to a board learning base in the clinical setting. We have been able to augment this learning with our simulation technology though.

f) Job market

- **Requirements of prospective employers:** The need for all nurses, including LVNs is high. When looking at just Siskiyou County this may not be represented but our graduates are being hired throughout the county and in neighboring counties. Community employers are pleased with our graduates mainly wanting to see more leadership experience.
- **Development in field:** The Department of Labor predicts a 12% increase in the need for LVN jobs between 2016-2026. LVNs within the community are hired at clinics, in long-term care, home health and hospice. A large majority of LVNs will

continue in their education to the Registered Nursing (RN) level which the Department of Labor Statistics predicts a 15% increase in need between 2016-2026.

III. Progress on Outcomes Assessment:

a) LVN Program Outcomes:

At completion of the program the student will:

1. Possess a broad base of nursing and supportive knowledge with an understanding of nursing principles and the nursing process.
2. Assist with the implementation, and continuing evaluation of the nursing care plan.
3. Observe, record, and report to the appropriate persons symptoms, reactions, and changes exhibited by the patient.
4. Perform selected nursing procedures with proficiency.
5. Assist with the rehabilitation of patients.
6. Demonstrate knowledge of legal and ethical considerations in nursing.
7. Apply knowledge of the basic communication process; utilize the knowledge of the dynamics of human behavior.
8. Demonstrate knowledge of physical, psychological, and social aspects of patient care for all age groups.
9. Assume responsibility for personal and vocational growth and development.

SLO progress:

b) Program/course/instructional improvements: The faculty independently access learning outcomes by course and by program on a routine bases for board reports but as a college for SLO assessment, this year (18-19) is deemed the "initialization year" in the SLO manual, so faculty are supposed to work with the SLO committee to create program maps, make any necessary changes to program-level outcomes, and develop their first key assessment (to be implemented next year). Unfortunately, there is no currently-functioning SLO committee.

c) Program's assessment plan for next two years:

- We will continue to assess minimally half of each course's SLO and continue to collect data after every graduating cohort to better assess the program level outcomes. Utilization of Canvas for course level SLO will be utilized.

IV. Institutional Program Effectiveness Indicators:

a) Our courses typically have a high completion and success rate due to it being CTE courses. Students entering CTE typically have a clear career path and have progressed through many other prerequisites to get to their career goal. The first semester of the LVN program (0951) typically has the highest non-completion rate. For the two years being reviewed (2015-2017), the follow data was given:

Course Retention Rate Average	Course Retention Rate Goal
0951=95.24%	95%
0952=97.77%	100%
0953=96.59	100%
0966=100%	100%

b)

Course Success Rate	Course Success Rate Goal
0951=91.37%	100
0952=96.73%	100
0953=94.52%	100
0966=100	100

c) **FT/PT Faculty Ratio/Impact on Student Success:**
   a. For the complexity of the curriculum and the BVNPT requirements it is more beneficial to have a higher number of FT faculty members. Having too many PT cover different clinical sites or theory content sections increases student stress. Nursing students, I feel more than any others, really need consistency for success. There are a multitude of studies that correlate stress and lack of success in nursing school performance. This is a high intensity program with many time demands, having consistency in who the students can contact and rely on presentation of expectations is pivotal.

V. Other Unit-Specific Quantitative/Qualitative Research

a) **Transfers, degrees, certificates, satisfaction, student contacts, Perkins data, equity data**
As mentioned above, many graduates of the Vocational Nursing Program apply to the LVN to RN Step-up program with the goal to become an RN. Graduates who meet general education requirements can receive an Associate's Degree in Science. Those who do not have the general education requirements receive a certificate. See section I e) above.
COS Vocational Nursing Program received a Silver Star award from the California Community College Chancellor's Office for NCLEX-PN pass rates and employment figures for 2017. Program evaluations indicate a high rate of satisfaction from program graduates and also from employers. COS LVN graduates are sought out regionally by outreach recruiters not only in Siskiyou County but also in Shasta County and Oregon. Annual NCLEX-PN pass rates for the past four years are: 100%, 98%, 95%, and 100%. The statewide and national annual averages are generally in the 75 to 85% range.

b) **Summary of results of these measures**
The COS Vocational Nursing Program is highly successful in student outcomes, employment opportunities, and overall satisfaction.

c) **What did you learn from the evaluation of these measures, what improvements have you implemented or plan to implement?**
The instruction is rigorous yet successful. The current curriculum needs updating to include simulation, which can augment clinical experience and provide back-up to low hospital census period and times with students cannot be in the hospitals due to hospital activities and reviews. BVNPT is requiring certification of simulation instruction and simulation centers, and COS Nursing is working on the certification process. A cost analysis of the program operations has indicated that cost saving measures must be instituted. The program is costing more than it is producing. COS Nursing is searching for the balance between the high demand for enrollment by applicants and the offering of courses.

VI. Evaluation

a) **Representativeness of population served:** see above comments. There is not a break-down of demographics specifically for the VN program, however in general enrollment reflects more diversity in the VN program than in the LVN to RN program.
b) **Alternative modes and schedules of delivery:** Canvas augmented classes, EHR, Hi fidelity simulation lab
c) **Partnerships:** Many of the local healthcare agencies (Fairchild Medical Center including the Clinic, Mercy Medical Center, Public Health department, local nursery schools for pediatric leaning objectives, Siskiyou Training and Employment Program (STEP).
d) **Innovation and Implementation of best practices:** Integrating learning through the use of simulation. Many faculty members seeking higher level degrees, additional training and advanced certifications to ensure high quality education is being delivered.
e) **Efficiency in operations:** Faculty are efficient in their time with students and providing learning. More online processes have been put in place for better communication among faculty. The utilization of Canvas has allowed a much better workflow not only for faculty but also for students.
f) **Efficiency in resource use:** Having an Assistant Director in the LVN program has allowed a better use of resources when it comes to BVNT evaluation and training requirements. It will be tremendously helpful for completing the program's curriculum revision.
g) **Staffing:** The nursing faculty currently consists of 4 full-time faculty members: 3 of which are qualified to teach between both the LVN and the ADN programs. Having a 5th and maybe even a 6th would decrease the need for so many adjuncts. Could help with retention of faculty which would help with consistency across all courses.
h) **Participation in shared governance:** 3 of the 4 FT faculty members have served or are currently serving on committees fulfilling this requirement (the 4th is in year one which committee duties not being recommended). All faculty regularly attend Senate and Association meetings. These can be difficult at times due to the wide variety of hours nursing course have but all faculty keep up to date.
i) **Professional development and training:** Within the last 3 years 2 of the faculty obtained their Master's in Nursing degrees. One faculty is pursuing a PhD. All faculty are about to complete Simulation Certification courses and certification through a national exam. Goal of at least one faculty is to obtain a Certified Nursing Education certificate and another has a goal of starting a Master's program within the next year. Nursing faculty have a licensure requirement to keep up to date on education. There are no concerns in this area except that the college practice does not recognize step or column movement for all of the additional training and certifications obtained. We are hoping this will change to help support all faculty members.
j) **Compliance with applicable mandates:** The nursing program is in compliance with all state regulatory agencies.

VII. **Vision:** To have a more progressive transition from the LVN to RN level nursing without the gaps in our current admission process. We will have a fully certified Simulation Center approved by both the BVNPT and the BRN. Nursing would like to have a more cohesive and supportive connection to the rest of the college and it's faculty.

VIII. Progress on Prior Goals:

IX. Two-year Action Plan:

- Plan is to have completely revised and updated curriculum approved and being utilized.
- Maintain our current NCLEX pass rates of 94-100% for first time attempts.
- Continue to implement cost savings to the college.

- Continue to admit cohorts of 30 students with re-evaluation of admitting multiple cohorts or only admitting after the graduation of a cohort.
- On board and retain enough faculty (both full time and part time) to effectively teach students.

We the undersigned certify that the LVN Program, program review process included broad dialogue about student learning, program effectiveness and resource allocation.

Kim Parham Principal Preparer

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